

HomeBase: Setup Guide

For phone, tablet, and laptop. Alpha 3, draft for testing.

Read this first

HomeBase runs in a web browser. Everything you enter is saved in that browser on that device, not in the cloud. Two devices only match when you send and merge a backup file (steps at the end).

The easiest way on a phone or tablet is a link to the app, then Add to Home Screen. A loose file saved on a phone is awkward to reopen, and some phones clear its data. The app itself holds no personal information. Your household data stays on each device.

Android phone or tablet (Chrome)

- 1 Open the link in Chrome.
- 2 Tap the menu (three dots, top right).
- 3 Tap Add to Home screen or Install app. The wording varies by phone.
- 4 Open HomeBase from the new icon. Choose your name from the menu at the top.

iPhone or iPad (Safari)

- 1 Open the link in Safari.
- 2 Tap the Share button (square with an arrow).
- 3 Tap Add to Home Screen, then Add.
- 4 From now on, open it from the home screen icon. Set up your household there. A Safari tab and the home screen icon keep separate data, so do not switch between them.

Laptop (Chrome, Edge, Firefox, Safari)

- 1 Open the link, or double-click the homebase.html file you saved.
- 2 Do not use a private or incognito window. It forgets everything when closed.
- 3 Bookmark it. In Chrome or Edge you can also choose Install in the address bar.

Opening the saved file on a phone (not recommended)

On Android you can open the file from your Files app with Chrome, but the phone may not keep your data. On iPhone this does not work well. Use the link instead.

Getting a link (free hosting)

To get a link, the file is placed on a free hosting service (such as Netlify, Cloudflare Pages, or GitHub Pages). The file must be named index.html. Anyone with the link can open the app, but it holds no household data, because your data stays on your own device. Do not type real names into the file itself before you host it. Tell me which service you prefer and I will walk you through it step by step.

First time using it

- 1 Tap the gear (top right) > Household. Rename it and add each person.
- 2 Use the menu at the top to pick who is using this device.
- 3 Add recurring things first: work shifts, school, chores, and monthly bills.
- 4 Use the Board for notes and questions. A red number on the Board tab means someone asked you something.

Sharing between two phones

- 1 On phone A: gear > Send my changes. Pick a messaging app and send the file to phone B.
- 2 On phone B: save the file, then gear > Merge a file from another device and choose it.
- 3 Both phones now hold the newest version of every item. Do the reverse to bring B's changes to A.

Keep your data safe

- 1 Clearing browser data erases HomeBase on that device.
- 2 Gear > Save backup file once a week and keep the file somewhere safe.
- 3 Use Replace everything with a backup to restore it.

Limits right now

No live sync, no notifications, and no logins yet. Two people checking off different dates of the same bill before merging can lose one change. Tell us what is missing; the feature checklist tracks every request.